PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Friday, January 30, 2026

Board Retreat

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Board Retreat of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at University of Oregon Portland Campus-Library and Learning Center, Room 310, 2800 NE Liberty St., Portland, OR 97211 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Participants:
Chair Eddie Wang; Vice-Chair Michelle DePass; Directors Rashelle Chase-Miller, Stephanie Engelsman, Virginia LaForte, Christy Splitt, and Patte Sullivan; and Superintendent Kimberlee Armstrong

Absent: Student Representative Ian Ritorto

Facilitators:
Amy Cast – Bombastic Communications
Sandy Hayes – Bombastic Communications

Attendees:
Kara Bradshaw – Confidential Executive Assistant; Board Clerk
Deborah Kafoury – Chief of Staff
Rosanne Powell – Senior Manager, Board of Education
Terry Proctor – Manager, Multimedia Services
Sharon Toncray – Chief Legal Officer

Introductions and Stage Setting

The Retreat was called to order at 12:09 p.m. by Board Chair Eddie Wang.

Facilitators from Bombastic Communications introduced the purpose of the retreat and agenda for the day. Board members and the superintendent participated in an icebreaker activity, and facilitators reviewed meeting norms, emphasizing the importance of creating a safe space for discussion, collaboration, and constructive dialogue.

Board Roles and Responsibilities

Board members and the superintendent reviewed the Oregon School Boards Association (OSBA) Standards for Boardpersonship and reflected on current practices, areas of strength, and opportunities for growth. Participants identified community engagement, vision-directed planning, accountability, and data-driven improvement as areas of collective strength. There was discussion regarding how the board can adapt its work to remain effective in the context of anticipated staffing reductions. Additional discussion addressed governance models, approaches to consensus and conflict resolution, and the importance of deliberation as part of effective decision-making.

Board members discussed the Science of Student Achievement article and shared reflections on how student-outcomes-centered governance should focus on classroom experiences, student learning, and data-informed decision-making. Participants expressed interest in revisiting and updating the district's strategic plan. The discussion also addressed how board agendas could better reflect a student-centered

focus while maintaining attention to facilities and bond-related priorities. Board members considered how to balance staff workload, improve the structure and purpose of committees, clarify processes for requesting information, and strengthen agenda-setting practices to align more closely with district goals.

Building Coherence

Facilitators introduced the Trust Matters framework, highlighting the importance of shared responsibility and collaboration among board members. Participants briefly reflected on how board work aligns with the five facets of trust.

Conclusion and Next Steps

Facilitators proposed several next steps, including developing clearer processes for submitting and prioritizing information requests, reviewing committee structures and charters, strengthening understanding of board policy, expanding participation in agenda-setting meetings, and coordinating facilitation efforts with upcoming board self-evaluation activities.

The retreat was adjourned at 5:14 p.m. by Board Chair Eddie Wang.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw

Executive Assistant / Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools